Volume 2: Faceless

Chapter 268: The Cemetery and The Hospital

Klein circled the outside of the cemetery a few times until the night truly set in, only then did he jump over its fence. He chose a tombstone and leaned against a nearby tree, playing with Azik's copper whistle as he waited. After twenty minutes of nothing happening, he decided to leave and come back a few days later to check if there were any differences.

Escaping the tomb keepers' sights, he found someone that was buried that same morning and waited for half an hour this time. He was able to confirm that the whistle had no effect on corpses that had undergone a purification ritual, which all the ones in a cemetery would have. His second group of test subjects were the bodies in a hospital's morgue; those wouldn't have been put to rest yet. But he first wanted to head home for a change of clothes (I still question the morality of this experiment).

On his way back, he was reminded of the night he had been resurrected from the dead; as back then he had also needed to walk from the cemetery to the city. He started to run to get rid of the melancholy that filled him. In the wee hours of the morning, Klein, wearing a worker's uniform, made his way into a charity hospital belonging to the Church of Steam. It housed many poor people who had died due to illness. Their bodies remained in the morgue awaiting either cremation or being donated to the medical schools.

As a Sequence 8 Clown, Klein easily snuck into the hospital's underground morgue without being noticed. Removing the seal on Azik's copper whistle, he felt like everything had suddenly become even more silent. He only counted two minutes before the corpse on a long table sat up, with the ones in the iron cabinets causing loud banging noises as they tried to escape. He immediately used three Requiem Charms to make sure all the corpses had gone back to sleep. This confirmed his theories about the corpses the whistle could affect and whether he could seal it.

[At that moment, he suddenly heard footsteps coming from the outside and saw a faint light seeping in. The elderly janitor had been attracted by the banging sound in the morgue. He was approaching with a lantern in hand!

Klein looked around, placing his hand on the door, he nimbly jumped up, stopping at the spot between the door and the ceiling. His fingers dug into the bumps and cracks as he maintained perfect balance.

The elderly janitor opened the door with his key and entered the morgue. He took a few steps forward, held up his lantern, and examined the iron cabinets and long tables, as well as the corpses.

Behind him, Klein nimbly jumped down and landed silently. Seizing the opportunity, Klein quickly escaped from the morgue. He used the janitor's room to hide for a few seconds before carefully returning to the upper floor.] (Klein's adventures as a clown)

Chapter 269: Clues to the Psychology Alchemists

Elsewhere, Audrey met up with Xio and Fors to give them the mission The Fool had assigned. Then, she asked if they had any leads regarding the Psychology Alchemists, with Fors saying that she would bring the noble girl with her to a gathering where the Spectator and Telepathist formulas had appeared.

It was already past 9 AM by the time Klein woke up, as he had been out the whole night (this is him waking up late??). He wrote a message next to his front door stating that he would be out as a precaution against a sudden visit from Millet Carter, who expected the detective to be out and about collecting information and organizing people, not sitting at home drinking tea and reading novels. He went to the Quelaag club where he saw Talim Dumont, the equestrian teacher who had recommended him.

[He sized up Klein and said with an odd smile, "Good morning. Mary and Doragu are getting a divorce."

Are you suspecting the reason why I joined the club? Relying on the Clown's ability, Klein easily made a surprised expression. "Really? That is really surprising!"]

Talim then told him that he had a friend who needed his help, so he wanted to know how food the detective's marksmanship and fighting skills were. Klein invited the man to watch him in the shooting range, and then he could test his fighting skills himself.

Chapter 270: Reporter

The Clown, who had practicing extensively, continuously hit the bullseye accurately, with the worst shot hitting the 8 ring. Once Talim was satisfied with his skills, he adopted a boxing stance.

["Come on, let me see the standard of your fighting skills. I can tell you frankly that I've received training as a trainee knight since I was young, and I've never let it go to waste."

As a Beyonder, if I can't even beat an ordinary man who has only received training, then I might as well die! Klein cursed silently.]

Klein gestured for his opponent to make the first move and, with the first punch, the detective didn't exert any strength as he blocked his hand and flipped him to the ground. Gaining the man's approval, Klein learned that the person who wanted to hire him was a reporter named Mike Joseph, but they would need to discuss the details of the job face to face.

Klein kept practicing multiple firearms until noon. When he was almost done with a lunch that could feed three of me, Talim introduced him to his reporter friend. Mike showed him one of the newspapers that was discussing the recent serial murders where the victims had their organs removed, showing that the latest was the 11th case. Klein was surprised that none of the official Beyonder organizations had cracked the case yet, guessing that the Devil pathway must have some sort of anti-divination powers for them to dare to commit such obvious murders.

Worried that helping in a private investigation without having been explicitly invited by the police would sour his relationship with them, Klein refused the commission. But Mike explained that he only wanted to write a report about what the victims had in common. Only one of the victims seemed to be an outlier to the pattern he had observed, so he wished to visit the place where she worked prior to her death. Worried that his questions would anger the people there, the reporter wanted to hire some temporary protection. Klein excused himself to wash his hands, taking this chance to do a divination before accepting the mission.

Chapter 271: Golden Rose

When the two arrived, Mike approached one of the workers who seemed to be of a similar age to the victim, acting as if he was wondering about the prices this place offered. He learned that she knew the victim, but Madam Lopez, the owner of the business, had forbidden all of them from talking about her. The reporter decided to speak to the owner directly, to "ask more about their business". Once they had gotten the woman's attention, he inquired about the young girl, immediately getting the answer that everything she knew had already been told to the police.

Klein stepped in to protect his employer, escorting him away before whispering to him that she was lying, claiming all sorts of signs because he had no way of explaining his Spirit Vision. Mike, believing that the woman's anxiety due to being questioned would lead her to leave a trace, wanted to go back in to spy on her and asked his bodyguard to deal with the bouncers.

["Sir, I'm only responsible for your protection, and that's against the law." Klein smiled in response.

"I'll pay you more! A total of five pounds based on the combat price from before! If there's another fight when we run, it would be 10 pounds!" Mike Joseph gritted his teeth.

"Deal!" Klein reached out and shook his hand.] (If there's one thing in this world that Klein loves, it's money)

As a Beyonder, it only took Klein a few seconds to incapacitate the two standing guard, then he and the reporter snuck into the side door. They heard her mention someone named Capim, saying that he shouldn't send anyone else for the following few days. Once they heard her approaching them, the two made their escape. As soon as they parted ways, a carriage stopped in front of Klein, with a middle-aged man stepping out of it.

He introduced himself as detective Isengard Stanton, who was working with the police on this case. He invited Klein onto the carriage for a chat.

Chapter 272: Observing Each Other

After the two got on, Stanton paid Klein for the information he had learned from his investigation with Mike. He then told him that Capim was a controversial magnate who was suspected to be part of a human trafficking scheme, but he remained free due to a lack of evidence. After asking about Sherlock Moriarty's name, they each went their separate ways.

In his carriage, Stanton was analyzing the man he had just met, noting how part of his appearance was refined and cultured, while other details were crude. He deduced that he was most likely hiding something, or he just had an unusual aesthetic sense. On another carriage, Klein was doing the same, having noticed an unusual indifference and rationality using his Spirit Vision. He guessed that the detective was either extraordinarily talented, or a Beyonder.

Klein's carriage took him to the Bravehearts bar, where he learned that Maric hadn't come for two days. He had felt like someone was watching him when he asked about the man, which probably meant that someone was looking for him. It seemed that him and Miss Bodyguard had sensitive identities, and were

on the run from a secret organization. Due to the current situation, Klein rationally abandoned the idea of asking Kaspars about other Beyonder gatherings. After heading to his small apartment in East Borough to divine above the gray fog that he wasn't being followed, he returned home. Flipping through the newspapers in his mailbox, he found the secret code that meant there would be another gathering organized by Eye of Wisdom the following evening.

Chapter 273: Handing Out A Formula

This time, Klein donned a disguise and changed his temperament while participating in the gathering, as he believed it would be suspicious for a new Beyonder to be able to have obtained multiple potion formulas within a week. This would have been much easier had he already been a Faceless. But then again, if he was a Sequence 6, he most likely wouldn't have been participating in such a low-level gathering.

As soon as they started, he announced that he wanted to sell the formulas to Sequence 9 Bard and Sequence 8 Light Suppliant of the Sun pathway. He chose not to sell formulas from the Spectator pathway in order not to attract the attention of the Psychology Alchemists, and he obviously wouldn't sell formulas from the Seer pathway as it involved himself and might expose his abilities and characteristics, including his strengths and weaknesses. And selling formulas from the Demoness pathway would cause too much harm.

A man accepted the deal, getting Eye of Wisdom to check the authenticity of the formulas. The elderly gentleman seemed to have a Sealed Artifact that allowed him to do that, Klein guessed that this was the 2-081 that he had talked about before, allowing him to imitate the powers of a Notary. Once this deal was completed, the Apothecary said that he brought some sedatives just as he had agreed with Klein but, as he was currently acting as someone else, Klein remained silent. He was delighted when he noticed that the man didn't recognize him.

Then, the same woman who sold weapons previously announced that she had some more, this was Klein's chance to obtain one to exchange with The Sun.

Chapter 274: Beyonder Weapon

After hearing the description of the two weapons, Klein had to bid on one of them to get it: an axe that had a certain chance of summoning lightning, with this chance being greatly increased in a thunderstorm. This effect was perfect for the City of Silver's environment. He then tried to buy the remaining ingredient needed for his Magician potion, but no one responded. After the gathering, he went to his apartment in East Borough and informed The Sun that The World had obtained a weapon. Once the bestowment ritual was prepared, the young boy – who was expecting a straight sword, broadsword, or a great sword – received the axe.

Chapter 275: Pound Family

Even though this wasn't what he was expecting, Derrick was satisfied with his new weapon and its effects, promising to collect the ingredients that The World needed as soon as he could. In a pub in East

Borough, Xio was lecturing a friend of hers before asking him to keep an eye out on Lanevus for her, and to inform her immediately if he ever found someone who looked like the portrait. She had already given this mission to many different informants that she knew, hoping that at least one of them would succeed.

On Thursday, Klein first checked on his investment, giving the prototype bike a trial ride. By the afternoon, he heard an illusory voice that sounded like Justice, taking note of his slightly messy home that he probably needed to hire someone to clean before heading above the gray fog. The young noble had already gathered information about the abject nobles, sacrificing a thick manuscript.

He found the information about the Pound family: their heirs died of serious illnesses, which meant their corpses were probably nowhere to be found, maybe even in that innermost room with the bloody door. The current baron inherited the family when he was only a child, so he was easily enticed by the servants to squander his fortune. He had even been reduced to a baronet in later years. In the final paragraph, Klein found the information he had wanted most: Baronet Pound's current address.

Chapter 276: Rafter Pound

In a house at the edge of Empress Borough (the area where the rich live), Rafter Pound was about to collapse into his bed when he noticed a figure with a face painted like a clown sitting quietly on a chair.

["I advise you not to do anything unwise. If you cooperate, I won't harm you, and I won't take away your belongings—if you still have any left."

"You, what do you want from me? Sivellaus Yard is just across the street!" (The local police station)

"I know, but I think I'm closer to you than you are to Sivellaus Yard." Disguised as a clown, Klein had changed his voice and tone as he warned, "And my purpose is just to ask you a few questions."]

The Baronet seemed like he had lost it as he spoke, so Klein wasn't sure whether his words were the truth, but he kept them in mind anyway: multiple people had questioned Rafter Pound about the previous viscount and his children (Rafter had only been a child, unable to answer), the servants had become cold and seemed to be looking for something (possibly the characteristics and items near the evil spirit), and no one let him call the police as he started suspecting everyone around him.

Klein tried to confirm whether the man knew of the underground ruins but couldn't get an answer, so he used a Slumber charm before searching his memories using a Dream charm; the previous questions were just so Klein could compare his conscious and subconscious answers. He saw scenes that matched the descriptions he had heard, but he was unable to probe further without triggering the Baronet's deep trauma.

Once that step was done, Klein summoned Rafter's spirit to ask him a few questions: the late viscount's last words to him were to "maintain the family and remember the glory of the ancestors." As for what the people were looking for, he didn't know. Satisfied with the result, Klein tidied up the place, used Azik's copper whistle to interfere with any possible divination, bowed to his victim, and jumped out the window.

After changing out of his disguise and returning home, Klein immediately headed above the gray fog. Fearing that the ancient structure had ties to the orthodox deities, he decided not to divine it directly. Instead, he would divine Rafter Pound's future and infer the past from it.

Chapter 277: Finalizing a Plan

The revelation he received implied a connection between the baronet's family and the Tudor family, with Klein suspecting that they could even be their descendants. That meant that the Pound family was searching for remains of the Tudor family in Backlund and found these ruins. However, the evil spirit didn't recognize them and even killed them, leaving even their Beyonder characteristics and mystical items irretrievable. The disappearance of multiple members of their family, would have garnered the attention of the royal household and the churches, so Rafter Pound – with the help of Beyonder powers – distorted his own memories so as to frighten himself into having mental issues. That way, the people sent by the churches and the royal family to question won't be able to get any answers, and even probing his spirit wouldn't work; as his fear was genuine.

Seeing as Rafter Pound hadn't seemed in a hurry to run away, Klein surmised that the evil spirit must shouldn't be able to escape without external help. So, Klein's new plan was to use explosives to burry these ruins so no one can find them, and maybe – once his Sequence was high enough – he could later finish it off himself. He would have to ask Kaspars if he knew any demolition experts.

[As for the true relationship between the Pound family and the Tudor family, and for Rafter's abnormality, he didn't want to probe too deeply into it.

"It's none of my business!" Klein grumbled and quickly plummeted down past the gray fog and returned to the real world.]

The next morning, Klein ran into Mike Joseph at the Quelaag club. The reporter informed him that he figured out who Capim was, and that he suspected that the young lady they were investigating was murdered by a copycat killer, not the actual serial killer that had been roaming the city.

In the evening, an informant got ambushed in his apartment. The intruder questioned him about who told him to investigate Lanevus. The man easily relented, giving away Xio's name, yet he wasn't spared. In a mere moment his body exploded, and his apartment was burned down.

Chapter 278: Free?

After dinner time, Klein headed to the Bravehearts Bar.

[Before he could muster a smile and say hello, Kaspars stopped what he was doing, straightened up, and glanced at him. "Maric isn't here. There are no other gatherings you want. I have nothing but weapons."

...Very familiar with what I want... Fortunately, I have a different goal today... Klein curled the corner of his lips and said, "I'm here to buy weapons."

Maric isn't here... From the looks of it, they've been exposed and are targeted by their enemies. They've decided to switch locations... Then I won't be able to contact Miss Bodyguard... And I was planning on tricking Millet Carter with Maric's zombies as my helpers... They'll keep a secret, they're obedient, and they're unafraid of death. Well, the premise of their obedience is when the influence of Azik's copper whistle is shielded... As he spoke, a series of thoughts flashed through Klein's mind.]

Klein requested some explosives, and just as he asked about a demolition expert, Miss Bodyguard – who Klein found out is called Sharron – appeared, claiming to be one. Though Klein found it weird that a Beyonder who was possibly at Sequence 5 was doing such odd side jobs, he still talked to her alone, telling her of his findings from questioning Rafter Pound.

Asking about the price of her help, Klein was surprised when she said it was free, so she explained that blocking the entrance would make it so only she could enter and collect any of the items or characteristics inside. Readily accepting the deal, Klein also requested she bring some of Maric's zombies along to act as his team of helpers.

Elsewhere, Xio found out through the newspapers that there was an explosion caused by a "gas leak" in her acquaintance's apartment, and she suspected that this was caused by her asking him to investigate Lanevus, even if such retaliation seemed too radical.

The next morning, Klein arrived at Millet Carter's home, accompanied by Sharron and three "assistants."

Chapter 279: Extreme Joy Begets Sorrow

After checking over the underground structure for anything they missed the previous time, Klein stood at the side as Sharron set up the explosives.

[While Klein's thoughts wandered and made all sorts of associations, Sharron finished setting up the explosives and, in passing, lit the fuse.

In passing? Lighting the fuse? Hey, hey, hey! Why didn't you give any warning? Only then did Klein jolt back to his senses and was startled. He quickly rushed out of the hall and entered the corridor outside.

As for the three zombies, they calmly followed behind him.]

After the explosion, Klein, looking like a mess, left along with the zombies after making sure that the evil spirit hasn't been freed. He met up with Millet Carter and told him that the structure was very unstable and collapsed as they worked, but things should be safer now. After getting paid, Klein separated from Sharron and the zombies, heading to the Quelaag club to practice his shooting.

On his way home, he encountered two officers inspecting the area with a police dog, possibly because of the serial murders that had occurred recently. As soon as they approached him, the dog caught the scent of gunpowder on Klein and started barking, causing him to hand in his gun saying that he found it on the ground. He agreed to accompany them to the station and for them to do a body search on him as long as his lawyer, Jurgen Cooper, was present.

Chapter 280: The First Step

In East Borough, the poor district in Backlund, Xio was investigating the deaths of people she had entrusted with the task of finding Lanevus. She felt it weird that Lanevus would just kill anyone who was looking for him instead of running away, but that must have meant that he was planning something big and so he couldn't leave. For now, the only clue she had was that someone died after spreading wanted leaflets about Lanevus at the docks, so she decided to report what she knew to Audrey before heading to the docks herself to watch the situation.

At the Cherwood Borough police station, Klein was allowed to leave without a search after signing his name since he was a well-known detective. As he was leaving, he paid Jurgen for his help in talking to the police.

[Without a trace of politeness, Jurgen received the payment and said, "If you're willing to enter into a formal partnership, then every time you come to the police station, I'll only charge you a pound. Of course, not for the cases that are serious. You have to understand that a large portion of the fees I charge will go to the office."

It's as if I would frequently be invited to the police station for some coffee in the future... Pui, they don't even give coffee. There's isn't even a cup of water! Before Klein could answer, he heard Jurgen add.

"For a private detective, getting in and out of the police station is something that happens every once in a while. It's an occupational hazard. Well, I know very well that every private detective has a problem with the illegal bearing of arms and the illegal trespassing in other people's homes.

"Your response this time was very good. The police couldn't find enough evidence to prove that you were bearing a gun illegally, and the explanation for the gunpowder reaction on your body was quite sufficient. The name Quelaag Club was enough to convince them; otherwise, you most likely would've had to go to the magistrate's court. So, you're not a suspect, but a good citizen. A good citizen who picked up a gun and handed it in, so there was no need for a body search."

Alright... But I lost a revolver and the corresponding bullets. That's several pounds, and there's also the lawyer's fee. Klein squeezed out a smile.

"I understand. Lawyer Jurgen, let's establish a formal partnership."

The corner of Jurgen's mouth twitched. With an extremely professional smile, he extended his hand and said, "I hope for a pleasant partnership. I sincerely hope that I don't have to see you too often at the police station."

That's not something that's up to me to decide... Klein gave a self-deprecating laugh.]

Back at home, Klein heard Miss Justice's illusory voice and headed above the gray fog to listen to her report on the Lanevus case. He tried to divine clues to the bounty hunter whose home had been burned down, bur all he saw was the destroyed apartment itself. This meant that either there were clues at the scene of the crime, or the killer was still stalking the place, waiting to finish off whoever would come to investigate.

As for how he would find someone who had hidden themselves so well, he was going to use the black eye left from Rosago to see the killer's Spirit Body Threads. Divining the level of danger of his plan, Klein put on a disguise in the real world before preparing to leave as he stared at his reflection in a mirror.

[Compared to when he was in Tingen City, Klein almost didn't recognize himself. One by one, he stretched out his fingers and clenched them into a fist. Looking at the mirror, he said in a low and hoarse voice, "Captain, this is the first step to avenging both you and me."

Before he finished his sentence, he saw himself grinning in the mirror, a brilliant smile on his face.]

Chapter 281: Clue

In East Borough.

[Klein encountered people with old, tattered clothes, their faces numb with despair. They were the homeless who had been chased away by the police. They had no place to sleep, so they wandered aimlessly through the streets. Occasionally, they would find some inconspicuous corner or park bench to rest at for a while, but they were soon chased away again. In the cold and dark night, Klein felt that they were more like zombies than the zombies he had seen, and the entire East Borough was more like an abyss than the legendary abyss.]

Arriving at the building across from the one that was burned down, Klein made his way in as he held onto some tarot cards in his pocket, since he no longer had a gun.

[After a split-second, his fingers touched the All-Black Eye, and the murmurs resounded in his ears as they attempted to tear his mind apart. At the same time, with the help of this corrupted item, Klein saw many strange black lines.

These thin lines floated in the air, and although they were intertwined and entangled a little, he could still distinguish who they belonged to if he traced them back to the source. The corresponding figures were reflected in Klein's soon-to-be-cooked brain. There were men, women, and children sleeping in the bunk beds, and several tenants lying in bed on the floor. Other than that, there were no other special spots, nor were there any hidden figures.

The illusion in front of him and the auditory hallucination in his ears slowly improved as Klein quickly retracted his hand from the All-Black Eye.]

Deciding to check the scene of the crime itself just in case, Klein was surprised to actually find Spirit Body Threads coming out of the destroyed apartment. (*That murderer is actually crazy enough to wait for investigators to come to the crime scene? Isn't he afraid that official Beyonders will take over the case? I made a wrong judgment and failed to find him because I shared a different sense of logic from that of a lunatic...*)

Heading over to the other building, Klein walked causally. As he passed the destroyed door of the target apartment, he touched the black eye, allowing him to see a very tall man merged with the shadows. Acting as if he was heading towards the public bathroom, Klein jumped out of its window and headed to his small rented apartment in East Borough. Heading above the gray fog, he divined whether he was caught, then sent the image of the man he saw to Audrey, telling her it was a clue.

Chapter 282: This is East Borough

Afraid of the murderer pursuing him, Klein spent the night at his rented apartment in East Borough and only left in the morning.

[While walking, he saw a man in his forties or fifties ahead of him. He wore a thick jacket and had gray hair around his temples. He was pacing in place and fumbling for a cigarette while shivering. Finally, he took out a box of empty matches in his clothes' inner pocket.

Just as he opened the matchbox, his right hand quivered, and the crumpled cigarette fell to the ground and rolled in front of Klein. Klein stopped, picked it up, and handed it to him.

"Thank you, thank you! I can't live without this old friend. There's only a few left," the man thanked him sincerely and accepted the cigarette. His face was pale, and he appeared to not have shaved for quite a while. Exhaustion was expressed without reserve from the corner of his eyes as he lamented, "I haven't slept for another night, I don't know how long I can last. I hope the Lord will bless me so that I can enter the workhouse today."

He's a homeless person who has been chased away. Klein casually asked, "Why doesn't the king and ministers allow all of you to sleep in the park?"

"Who knows? But to sleep in this kind of weather outside, it's very likely that you'll never wake up again. It's still better in the day, since you can find a warmer place. *Sigh*, but this will make us lack the time or strength to look for jobs." The man lit a cigarette and sucked at it delightfully.]

[Klein had no intention of exchanging pleasantries and was about to speed away from him when he saw the man, who had spoken clearly, bend down and pick up a dark object from the ground. It looked like an apple core that had been nibbled clean. The man swallowed his saliva before stuffing the dirt-covered fruit core into his mouth. He chewed it until it was mashed up before swallowing it down with great familiarity. Nothing was left.

Looking at Klein's surprised eyes, he wiped his mouth, shrugged his shoulders, and smiled bitterly.

"I haven't eaten in almost three days."]

Feeling sympathetic for the man, Klein introduced himself as a reporter who was interviewing homeless people. The two entered a budget café where Klein ordered food for both of them, allowing the other to eat first before asking any questions.

[Klein wasn't a professional journalist and was momentarily at a loss on what to ask.

He turned his head to look out the window and saw faces with obvious hunger plastered across them. Some of them were relatively sober and they belonged to the residents of East Borough. Some of them wore looks of numbness and exhaustion, nothing like that of humans. They were tramps.

There is no obvious gap between the two, the former can easily become the latter. For example, the gentleman in front of me... When Klein looked back, he discovered that the man had fallen asleep; his body curled up on a chair.]

After allowing the man to sleep for a few minutes, he paid him for the interview before making his way out of the café. At noon, Klein attended a party at the Sammers' place where the lady of the house talked about how much everything cost and how Sherlock should soon be able to host such parties himself as they were "essential for people of their class."

At the docks, Xio entered a tavern, hoping to gather information about the tall man whose portrait Audrey had sent her. What she hadn't expected, however, was for that man to enter the exact same tavern as she was there.

Chapter 283: Dock Union

Acting normal, Xio finished her food before walking out of the tavern, finding a secluded place to watch its entrance. After a while, she found an acquaintance she could trust and asked if he knew the man she was looking for. The man said that he didn't even know the other's name, but knew that he was a very good fighter who only ever appeared at the tavern or the Dock Union.

After warning her acquaintance not to tell anyone about what she asked – as that would put him in danger – Xio made her way to the Dock Union. She watched the building for a while before a group of workers made their way out, one of them looking suspiciously like Lanevus.

At the Sammers' place, Klein was hanging around with Jurgen Cooper, occasionally joining in on some of the other guests' conversations.

[Klein smiled, turned his body slightly, and asked in a low voice, "Are you bored?"

"No, their topics are very interesting." Jurgen nodded seriously.

Klein was stunned and blurted a question, "Then why don't you laugh?"

Jurgen frowned slightly and looked at him in puzzlement. "Why are you smiling?"

"..." Klein's mouth twitched, not knowing how to respond.]

Hearing an ethereal female voice, Klein excused himself to the bathroom and headed above the gray fog where he listened to Audrey's report about Xio's findings. He tried to find out whether there was danger at the Dock Union, but the divination failed, so he decided to head there himself. Since Xio was able to gather information without getting caught, why couldn't he?

But to do that, he was going to borrow a false reporter identification from Mike Joseph so he could go under the pretext of doing interviews. Once the plan was set, he returned to the real world.

Chapter 284: Instinctive Trembling

In the afternoon, Klein headed to the Dock Union with only a deck of tarot cards, a stack of notes, a fountain pen, a wallet, some change, a bunch of keys, and false reporter identification documents. He didn't bring any mysticism-related items in fear that Lanevus or the powerful Beyonder at his side would be able to detect them. After showing his fake identification, he was escorted around the place as he

interviewed the workers about their daily life and their work, before he was finally led into one of the offices.

[Klein smiled, took two steps forward, and made a gesture to shake hands with each and every staff member in the room.

At that moment, he saw a slightly familiar figure.

Although the man's skin had turned bronze, his ordinary round face had become angular, and his glasses had changed from a round frame to a gold-rimmed frame, Klein still found a trace of familiarity from his spirituality as a Seer.

Immediately afterward, his body trembled, and the smile on his face almost went out of control.

"I-I'm sorry. I suddenly have a stomachache. May I ask, where the washroom is?" Klein asked with an awkward smile, holding his stomach with the hand that didn't hold a pen and paper.

Rand and the staff didn't suspect anything. They all pointed to the door and said, "Go out, turn left. When you reach the end, you'll see the sign."

Klein smiled apologetically and walked out of the room, heading quickly for the washroom. Inside, he selected the cubicle closest to the window, sat on the toilet, and locked the wooden door behind him. He bent down, the corners of his mouth curving into a silent laugh. He laughed so hard he nearly couldn't keep his body straight. A drop of sparkling liquid fell onto the ground from his laughter.

Klein had confirmed that it was Lanevus!]

After regaining his composure, Klein continued the interviews as if nothing had happened and left the Dock Union. As he walked, a carriage stopped in front of him. In it was the detective Isengard Stanton (refer to chapter 271 and 272). The other explained that he was there for the serial murders case. After exchanging a few pleasantries, Klein made his way to the Quelaag club where he headed above the gray fog to divine whether he was being followed. Only then was he able to truly relax.

[Then, he sat up straight and prepared to answer Miss Justice's prayer.

Klein controlled his emotions and said in a deep but cold voice, "There's no need for confirmation. That is Lanevus. You can inform the Church of Evernight and tell them that Lanevus has the godhood of the Fallen Creator."

...

Audrey, who was watching her father train the hunting hounds with Susie, froze when she heard Mr. Fool's response.

Fallen Creator... Isn't that the True Creator? That swindler actually has the godhood of the True Creator? Th-this, such a simple mission actually involves the godhood of the True Creator!? As expected, I knew Mr. Fool had other deeper motives... He was targeting the True Creator. As expected of Mr. Fool! Many thoughts flashed through Audrey's mind.]

Chapter 285: Midnight Clock Tower

I'm still too weak... If not for that, I would've chosen to take revenge myself, but right now I can only take a step back... Were Klein's thoughts as he relayed his message to Audrey. Having once been a Nighthawk himself, he knew that the pursuit of Lanevus would happen that same night. During the afternoon interview, he had learned that Lanevus was staying at the dormitory provided by the Dock Union, so he was going to watch him get caught from the dock's clock tower.

[Taking a few steps forward, Klein hid in the shadows, got a sense of his bearings, and looked towards the Dock Union's dormitory. It was a two-story, brick-red building, and the occasional pedestrian resembled a black dot in Klein's eyes.

He stared for a few seconds, then took a step back, and sank into the darkness. At the same time, he took out his newly bought mask and wore it. It was a clown with the corner of its mouth sharply raised and a painted red nose.

A happy clown.]

Once the clock passed 1 AM, Klein, who was wearing a clown mask, observed an airship silently approaching the building, ready to provide surveillance in case the target tried to escape. Three Nighthawks appeared at the entrance, one of them being Crestet Cesimir, one of the Church of Evernight's Red Gloves. (He was the one who came to test Klein in season 1 before allowing him to advance to Sequence 8)

The tall murderer tried to stop the Nighthawks, but they used a Sealed Artifact to keep the civilians in the building safe while taking him down. More members of the Aurora Order appeared until, at last, Lanevus showed himself.

["I'm very curious. To the Aurora Order, you should be a blasphemer. Why would they send people to protect you?" Cesimir didn't seem to notice the abnormality as he asked casually.

Lanevus showed his trademark taunting smile and said, "That's simple. Because I'm no longer just Lanevus." He paused for a moment, and his gaze suddenly turned cold. "Now, I'm even more of the True Creator!"]

Chapter 286: A Taunting Smile

In the clock tower, Klein couldn't see the details of the battle, but he felt frozen in fear as the aura of the True Creator spread and reached him. Then a serene darkness engulfed the area, and the two forces canceled each other out. He tried to divine whether Lanevus was still dangerous, and the answer was yes, but not to a severe degree. What caught Klein's attention, however, was the fact that the divination hadn't failed; this meant that the Nighthawks were successful in separating Lanevus from the aura of the True Creator and stopped yet another one of his descent attempts.

Believing that he could now help, Klein took four steps counterclockwise to divine Lanevus's escape route above the gray fog. He didn't hesitate to return to the real world and jump off of the clock tower, hanging onto whatever he could as he quickly made his way down, before rushing to the sewers.

Back in the dormitory, Cesimir was the only one still conscious and facing off against Lanevus.

[Lanevus moved with great difficulty before suddenly laughing loudly. He said with a maniacal laugh, “Haha, haha, thank you! I really need to thank you! For real. Look at my sincere eyes. I really want to thank you! If you hadn’t discovered me and arrived in time, I would truly become the vessel of the True Creator when ‘He’ descends in a few months. When that happens, how different would it be from dying?”]

[When Lanevus saw his confusion, he coughed and said with a smile, “Do you know? To people like me, it’s the most miserable thing when there’s no one to share a great accomplishment that I’m proud of. *Cough*, when I was in Tingen City, I was deceived by the True Creator who not only initiated the descent of his spawn, but he also secretly planted a ‘sapling’ in my body.

“No, I even believe that Megose’s child was just ‘His’ ruse. ‘He’ didn’t even get the members of the Aurora Order to protect her to divert attention. It was as though ‘He’ knew from the beginning that the ploy would end in failure. ‘His’ true descent was set up inside me. The godhood ‘He’ bestowed upon me suddenly combined with the ‘sapling’ in my body after I reached Backlund. Haha, can you imagine that? I was being replaced bit by bit by ‘Him!’ In the end, I would become the True Creator…”]

[“Thankfully, if the True Creator wishes to fully descend and completely replace me, He’ll need large amounts of pessimism, despair, numbness, resentment and primitive evil. Only Backlund—only East Borough, the factory and dock area, could satisfy His requirements. This gave me a chance to interact with others.

“I knew that it was unrealistic to report this to the police simply through the people I interacted with because the people I come in contact could very well be members of the Aurora Order. I initially wanted to instigate a strike to get the police to notice me, but I was warned by someone from the Aurora Order. After being tortured, I could only hastily end it.”]

Lanevus successfully diverted Cesimir’s attention by endangering one of the unconscious Nighthawks, giving himself the chance to escape before they recovered. He made his way into the sewers.

[Lanevus seemed to be very familiar with this place. Even though it was dark, he could still run, jump, and turn, quickly fleeing deep into the maze of sewers. Suddenly, he instinctively stopped and leaned back.

A card had stabbed deep into his right chest and blood began dripping profusely from its edge. Lanevus looked up, and with his ability to see in the dark, he saw his attacker. It was a medium-sized man in a worker’s uniform, wearing a mask with a raised mouth and red nose.

It was a happy clown.]

Chapter 287: Death Battle

An assault of tarot cards was rained upon Lanevus, most of them he could dodge, but two hit their mark. He took a third as he advanced towards the clown, and the two started exchanging punches and kicks. Using his Clown’s intuition, Klein activated a Slumber Charm, surprising Lanevus as it would affect both of them and allow the Nighthawks to find them. However, Klein’s uniqueness allowed him to immediately break free from the charm’s effect.

Klein took this chance to land a punch that broke Lanevus's bones and threw two tarot cards, each getting stabbed into one of Lanevus's eyes.

[…he took two steps and arrived behind him. He reached out with his arms and grabbed his enemy's neck. Klein's arms exerted force, and he suddenly turned around, twisting Lanevus's neck! After doing all of this, he took two steps back and looked at his enemy.

With the card embedded in him, Lanevus looked ahead weakly as he slumped to the ground. At the same time, he was very confused and asked in a staccato manner, "Why... do you... want to... kill me..."

With his clown mask on, Klein stared at his archenemy and replied indifferently, "No reason."]

[Finally, his breathing came to a stop. At that moment, Klein, who seemed to be extremely calm, suddenly stepped forward, tightened his right leg, and, with all his strength, kicked him in the head. His neck, which was already badly mutilated, could no longer bear the pressure and was sent flying like a rubber ball. It slammed heavily into the wall…]

[Upon seeing this scene, Klein suddenly crouched down. He laughed crazily with a suppressed voice. The "clown" mask looked so very happy. The corners of those raised lips, the bright red nose, and that white face wore a very happy expression. Klein laughed so much that he went out of breath; his laughter was more jarring than crying.

After a few seconds, he finally calmed down. He slowly straightened his body and winked with his left eye at the darkest part of the sewer. Then, he smirked and muttered to himself, "Captain... Look, we've saved Loen once again..."

Droplets of liquid quietly slid down and landed on his collar.

At that moment, he felt that his Clown potion had been digested completely.]

Chapter 288: A Scene Filled with Symbolism

Searching Lanevus's body, Klein only found a strange badge. He had no time to collect all the scattered taro cards in the dark, so he dumped the rest of them on the headless corpse laying before him. These were standard ones that couldn't be traced back to him, and he had been wearing gloves the whole time so he wouldn't leave any fingerprints. He used Azik's copper whistle to distort any future attempts at divining the scene of the battle, and he was wearing a mask as well. Two minutes after he left, a group of Nighthawks, led by Crestet Cesimir, arrived to see the strange scene of Lanevus's death.

At his apartment in East Borough, Klein threw everything on him above the gray fog. He was too exhausted to study the badge he got from Lanevus, so he returned to the real world to rest.

[After completing his initial revenge, he felt that he had relieved himself of a lot of his burdens and lost a lot of his pressure. His mental state was clearly much better than before.

The present me isn't capable of handling Ince Zangwill and Sealed Artifact 0-08. Besides, the gap between us is huge. Only after becoming a High-Sequence Beyonder, a demigod, would I have the qualifications to involve myself in such matters... Before advancing to Sequence 4, I'll act as though they don't exist...

Yes, for the foreseeable future, my goal is to work hard to improve myself. Now that I've completely digested the Clown potion, I can advance to Magician once the Beyonder ingredients are gathered. There's still Faceless, Marionettist, and the corresponding Sequence 4 which I don't know the name of. Other than that, I'll just be an ordinary detective.

Klein's mind was calm and peaceful, and his thoughts were scattered as he thought about his future arrangements. He was no longer cranky or that depressed. As he thought about it, the corners of his lips curled up slightly as he silently muttered to himself. *Captain, Benson, Melissa, I believe all of you would prefer to see me like this...*]

The next morning, Audrey heard from her friend, Viscount Glaint, that a large ploy by the Aurora Order was stopped, with someone named Lanevus being killed by an unknown outsider, his body covered in tarot cards. She immediately connected the news to The Fool's recent orders, believing it to be the work of his Blessed.

Chapter 289: Conjecture and Investigation

The Nighthawks continued to investigate the mysterious person who killed Lanevus, finding out he was a Sequence 8 Clown, which made them guess he was part of the Secret Order. However, the scene of Lanevus's death didn't seem to fit their understanding of them, so they guessed he might also be part of an organization they didn't yet understand or an independent actor with tarot cards being a personal preference of his. They had also caught onto Xio having investigated Lanevus and reported him to them recently but found no connection between her and the Clown.

When investigating the reporter who had interviewed the dock workers that afternoon, they found out he was actually a private detective. But, due to his previous work with Mike Joseph and his encounter with Isengard Stanton that day, they concluded that he was there to get leads on the serial killer. They similarly couldn't find anything wrong with all those they could connect to Lanevus. Their meeting concluded with them deciding to be more careful of retaliation from the Aurora Order, and to pay more attention to the mysterious Beyonder who seemed to have no motive for killing Lanevus.

Meanwhile, Klein took his time waking up and spending his day relaxing until it was time to head above the gray fog. After conjuring The World and notifying The Sun, he waited until precisely three to summon the members of the Tarot Club.

[Audrey directly looked towards the seat of honor and said cheerfully, "Good afternoon, Mr. Fool. The 'simple' mission you entrusted has been completed."

She had deliberately emphasized the word "simple" in order to ascertain from Mr. Fool whether Lanevus had really been eliminated by his Blessed. She wanted to know if the tarot card-covered death scene was a symbol of the Tarot Club.

Klein deliberately acted composed as he said with a smile, "I'm already aware."

After saying that, he sighed. "In such an age, in such a place like Backlund, in such a place in the East Borough, the dock area, and the factory district, they're the hotbeds for an evil god's descent."

What? Alger was stunned for a moment, wondering if there was something wrong with his ears. *Why would a simple mission involve hotbeds for an evil god's descent?*]

Chapter 290: Effecting Change Indirectly

After The World described the situation in East Borough, indirectly encouraging Audrey to push for change among the nobility, Alger conjured the last page of Roselle's diary that he had promised to The Fool. The first entry was about how High-Sequence Beyonder objects, if not sealed, would attract nearby Low-Sequence Beyonders of the same pathway.

Klein had previously believed that he was the one being attracted to the Seer pathway (such as when he found the Antigonus notebook, or his encounter with Rosago that gave him the corresponding potions for Sequences 7, 6, and 5). But the more he used the gray fog, the more he believed it to be connected to the Seer pathway, in which case it would be the cause for the strong attraction force between its owner, Klein, and anything related to the Seer pathway.

In the last entry, Roselle wrote that he finished the second Card of Blasphemy, and that he would hide it as a bookmark in a very valuable book so that only someone "fated" would find it. Klein was disappointed that Roselle didn't specify which book it was. During the gathering's exchange, The World asked about some potion ingredients. Alger said that there was going to be a gathering of pirates soon, during which he could try to find them for him, but what was he willing to offer in exchange?

Chapter 291: Seller and Notary In One

The World offered the incomplete formula for Sequence 4 of the Sun pathway: Unshadowed, which would cover the ingredients and still have Alger owe him some money. Klein believed it would be useful since the Sailor and Bard (Sun's Sequence 9) pathway were exchangeable at high sequences. The gathering members were surprised at The World possessing an incomplete formula for a High Sequence, but Alger still refused, saying he had no need for it.

In its place, The World offered some knowledge about the High Sequences, with Alger agreeing as long as The Fool judged the information to be of equal value to the ingredients. The information was the existence of Sequence 0, the Sequence of the powerful deities, and that it had its corresponding potion and ritual. Audrey and Derrick agreed to look for and exchange the Sequence 7 formulas for the Sun and Dragon pathways, and Audrey decided to keep attending Beyonder gatherings in the hope of encountering the Psychology Alchemists.

During the discussion section, Alger mentioned the rise of a new pirate admiral in Qilangos's place.

Chapter 292: Exchanging News

Her name was Tracy, a Sequence 5, with his description of her abilities matching those of the Assassin pathway. Audrey asked Alger to introduce all the pirate kings and admirals, since she was a noble lady who knew nothing about the affairs of the sea.

The strongest of them was the King of the Five Seas, Nast, a descender of the Fourth Epoch's Solomon Empire, adept at using "order," who had been active since the Roselle era and is rumored to be over a hundred years old. There was also the High-Sequence Queen Mystic, who was once a Warlock (Sequence 7 of the Mystery Pryer pathway).

As for the admirals, there were: Ludwell (once a follower of Nast, with connections to the Numinous Episcopate, rumored to possess a ring left behind by the ancient Death), Admiral of Stars Cattleya (once a follower of Queen Mystic, a member of the Moses Ascetic Order who possessed the Mystery Pryer pathway and followed the Hidden Sage).

(There are more kings and admirals, but they weren't elaborated on here.)

As for the news Audrey shared, it was about the serial killer in Backlund who had been opening his victims' stomachs and removing all of their internal organs. Neither her nor Alger knew much about similar rituals, so they couldn't judge whether or not he was part of the Blood Sanctify Sect. Derrick, however, mentioned that such information was included in the City of Silver's Devil Studies, and that this was a ritual for Devils, from the Abyss pathway, trying to advance from Sequence 6 to 5. This made Klein guess 2 sequences on this pathway: Sequence 6 Devil, and Sequence 0 Abyss.

After Derrick shared details about the mannerisms of such Beyonders, he said that the City of Silver had recently, while out on an expedition, discovered a temple with a statue whose description matched the True Creator, with The Fool telling them so.

Chapter 293: Derrick's Worry

Alger told Derrick about the followers of the True Creator and the sequences of the pathway they possess. Once he reached Shepherd, Derrick was alarmed, as one of the City of Silver's Elders, named Lovia, was a Shepherd, and she had been acting stranger lately. Once the discussion was done, The Fool dismissed them before taking out the badge he had gotten from Lanevus.

Injecting some spirituality into it, he found the time and location of a gathering that would be held the following year, but he couldn't gain any more from it. He decided to only go if he was able to advance to Faceless and disguise himself before then, but for the time being he had to focus on becoming a Magician, along with how to act as one.

Elsewhere, Fors and Xio had gone into hiding to not get involved in the ruckus of the Lanevus situation, while Audrey was preparing to make the following potion for Susie.

Chapter 294: Admiral of Stars

While Klein was testing the new bike prototype, Leppard told him that there was going to be an "Emperor Roselle Memorial Exhibition" at the Royal Museum the following week, during which they would show many of Roselle's original blueprints and relics. Klein said he would take the time to visit it, advised Leppard to find more investors in their project, and left.

On a random island in the sea, different pirate ships arrived for the gathering, including Alger, Tracy, and Cattleya. While in Backlund, Audrey received the final ingredient needed to make Susie a Sequence 8 Beyonder.

Chapter 295: All Ingredients Gathered

Remembering a very important detail about potions, Audrey explained to Susie what is felt like to completely digest a potion and asked her whether she had ever experienced that before, with Susie's answer being 'yes.'

[*Ah? Susie has completely digested the Spectator potion? B-but no one taught her the acting method! At most, I would occasionally remind her to observe more and remain calm...* Audrey asked in astonishment, "When did you digest it?"

"Last month, the month before last, or perhaps even earlier..." Susie tried her best to recall when. Seeing that her mistress's expression was getting odder and odder, she hurriedly wagged her tail and timidly added, "I don't remember... I'm just a dog. I won't purposely remember such things. Woof."

Just a dog... But you were only a little slower at digesting than me... Don't tell me that when I interact with other Beyonders, I'll say that when it comes to digesting potions, I'm a little better than a dog...]

While taking an afternoon nap, Klein was awakened by an illusory male voice. The thought of obtaining an ingredient for the Magician potion was enough to make him forget about his annoyance at being woken up as he headed above the gray fog. Indeed, Alger had already acquired the two promised ingredients and by Wednesday, Derrick also sacrificed the ones he had owed.

Not wasting any time, Klein brought all the ingredients into the real world and concocted the potion in the kitchen, using divination once he was done to make sure there was nothing wrong with it. Sitting down on the sofa, Klein calmed his mind before gulping down the potion.

He felt overstimulated as massive amounts of information flooded his mind, with whispers of "Hornacis" and "Flegrea" repeating over and over. His body underwent worrisome changes as he feared losing control, but he slowly cleared his thoughts and recovered.

[*It's a good thing that no one came knocking on the door or ringing on the bell... I only chose to advance after completely digesting the Sequence 8 potion. With such severe effects, it would be hard for those Beyonders who depended on time to grind through the potion. It really is difficult to pass this stage.*

No wonder Captain took nine years...]

[After sitting silently for more than ten seconds, Klein slowly stood up.

At that moment, he was already a Mid-Sequence Beyonder.

At that moment, he was already a Magician.]

Chapter 296: Magician

Klein took a moment to assess himself and what new abilities he gained.

[The most important one was, Damage Transfer!

As long as he didn't die instantly, as long as his hands could still move, he could transfer the vital wounds to unimportant areas like his arms, turning fatal wounds into minor injuries. This was a very useful Beyonder ability for life-preservation in actual combat.

The only problem is that at Sequence 7, wounds can only be transferred around my body, and there's only one opportunity.]

[The second spell was Flaming Jump. Within a range of 30 meters, he could phase between a fire spark that he had left behind and any flame that existed. It was similar to teleportation which seemed to gain its uniqueness with help from the spirit world.]

[The third type of Beyonder spell was the Air Bullets which Klein had seen the suited Clown from the Secret Order use.

The Magician could produce air projectiles with power and speed comparable to that of the bullets fired from a custom revolver just by snapping his fingers or mimicking sounds. Furthermore, the effect would improve along with the digestion of the potion and the raising of his Sequence. Klein suspected that at Sequence 4 or 5. he could create his own cannonball.

This way, I don't need to buy more revolvers and bullets anymore—No, I still need to buy one. There are many matters that don't need me to expose my Beyonder powers. Any problem that can be solved with guns isn't a problem. Klein nodded indiscernibly and began to examine the other spells and spell-like abilities.

The fourth type was Paper Figurine Substitutes. At a critical moment, the magician could temporarily change the paper figurine into him while he swapped places. It was a relatively simple substitute spell that could not only block a fatal blow but also weaken the damage from hexes.]
(Paper figurines were used by the magician in episode 2 of season 1)

[The fifth kind of spell-like ability was called Flame Controlling. As the name implied, one could manipulate flames within a range of 30 meters with a simple action. It could also be used to ignite certain items within this range. *Once the potion has been completely digested, or when I advance in Sequence, one could summon a swirling flame out of thin air.*

The sixth was Illusion Creation. By influencing the surrounding environment, one could create illusions with colors, sounds, and smells that were close to reality, allowing one to pass off the fake as the truth and deceive the enemy.]

[The seventh was a fake form of Underwater Breathing. The principle behind it was to create a thin, invisible air pipe which would allow the Magician to breathe freely and seemingly turn into so-called murlocs.

The problem was that the air pipe had a limited length. At his present stage, Klein could only maintain it at around five meters, which meant that if the water depth exceeded five meters, he could drown.]

[The eighth was a spell-like ability, Bone Softening. This helped a Magician break free from handcuffs, ropes, and chests.]

[The ninth was the evolution of the Clown's ability to turn paper into throwing knives, called Drawing Paper As Weapons. Not only could it turn paper into sharp objects, but it could also temporarily turn into weapons such as bats or bricks, etc.]

Just as Klein was done, a Blood Moon appeared in the night sky. While the moon phases were similar to the ones he was familiar with from his life on earth, the red moon would, on occasion, become round and dark red, for seemingly no reason despite how much the phenomenon had been studied.

In an apartment not too far away, Fors experienced intense pain from the ravings the Blood Moon unleashed upon her. Chanting different Honorific Names and praying didn't help as she stumbled around, knocking into everything around her, believing she was going to die.

Her eyes landed on the Honorific Name written in Ancient Hermes that Xio had stumbled upon before. Even had it been an evil spirit, she was willing to do anything if it would save her from this agony.

And so, she called for The Fool Who Doesn't Belong to This Era.

Chapter 297: The Full Moon's Ravings

Klein, who was preparing to leave his home, heard the illusory voice of a woman who sounded in a lot of pain. Thinking that he had nothing better to do, he took four steps counterclockwise, finding himself in the seat of The Fool. He was surprised to find the source of the prayer to be a star not connected to any of the Tarot Club members. When he touched it, he heard Fors's words more clearly, noticing she was on the brink of losing control. Believing her state to be similar to the ravings he experienced, he pulled her above the gray fog in the hopes it would separate her from them.

Fors suddenly found her mind clear and, as she opened her eyes, she noticed the strange place she was in, along with the figure sitting at the head of the table. Despite her fear, she bowed to him, recognizing that he must have been The Fool.

As Klein observed the image that formed behind her chair, he noticed it looked like a door, immediately connecting it to Mr. Door from Roselle's diary who would come close to the real world and cry for help every full moon. This meant that the ravings she heard must have been from Mr. Door.

As Fors was overthinking what this mysterious existence could want in return for saving her, he interrupted her. He explained that the ravings might just be someone asking for help, but she was still too weak to hear them, as the being crying out was way more powerful.

[*Could it be that those terrifying ravings really come from an existence who's nearly a god? Mr. Fool can help me eliminate that person's influence, and all this time, he's been talking about it in a rather bland tone... Does this mean that he and that existence's life's natural order are at the same level?* The more she thought about it, the more shocked she became. Even her body couldn't stop trembling.]

She asked if she could recite his Honorific Name every time a full moon or a blood moon appeared (to which he agreed) before noticing there were many more chairs around her. The Fool explained the existence of the Tarot Club, and she asked if she could join.

[“They’ve decided to use the names of the tarot cards as their code names. You can pick one of these, but these already belong to someone and you cannot choose from...”

Fors nodded her head, shuffling the cards and cutting them with great interest while mumbling, “Let fate arrange my title...”

Soon, she pulled out a card and looked at it: “The Magician!”]

Chapter 298: Another Case

After sending Fors back, Klein contemplated the situation until he felt his spirituality being depleted, forcing him to return to the real world to rest. The next morning, the newspapers mentioned the serial killer adding another victim, and Klein learned that there will be another one of the gatherings hosted by the Eye of Wisdom.

As for his plans, he wanted to cut some paper figurines, find inspiration for a Magician’s acting, already start looking for the ingredients needed for Faceless, and find out how to remove corruption from an object so he could cleanse the black eye he had gotten form Rosago.

[When it was almost noon, he put down the scissors and looked at the three crude paper figurines in front of him. He sighed and muttered to himself, *This is probably the first time in my life that I’ve done handicraft so seriously Fortunately, it’s just to cut out some paper figurines and not flowers or embroidery. It’s fine as long as it’s shaped like a person! Sigh, if it wasn’t for the fact that my hands have become dexterous, I might’ve failed today...*]

Just as he was preparing to go out, the doorbell rang. It was a man whose son, named Adol, had a falling out with friends who were bad company, and are now after him. The man had hired some body guards along with four private detectives to protect his son, but as one of the detectives had an accident, he needed to quickly find a replacement. Klein casually flipped a coin in his hand, briefly glanced at it, then agreed to take the job.

Chapter 299: Snapping Fingers

As Klein followed to man to his home, he met Adol, who was shivering despite how hot his room was. Klein used his Spirit Vision to examine the boy, finding signs of hauntings or even possession by wraiths.

[By the oriel window stood a man in a black coat. He was tall and sturdy, not smiling, and his waist was bulging as if he were hiding a gun.

This should be one of the six bodyguards... Klein was about to size up another person when Rogo Colloman introduced, “Detective Kaslana; her assistant, Lydia. Detective Stuart.”

At this point, Rogo turned around and pointed at Klein. “This is Detective Sherlock Moriarty.”]
(I just had to include the name Kaslana)

[Stuart, who was sitting there, turned his head to size Klein up and chuckled. “You didn’t bring a gun?”

“Gun? This is my gun.” Klein smiled and raised his cane. At the same time, he puffed out his cheeks to stimulate a sound.

Bang!

The sound of a gunshot rang out, and without thinking, Stuart rolled over, while Kaslana and Lydia quickly got off the sofa, each finding a place to hide. Rogo and the servant beside him were both surprised and confused about what was happening. Adol continued keeping his head low as he shivered.

When they saw that Klein was only holding onto a black cane and realized that nothing had happened, Kaslana and company calmed down. They frowned and asked, “What just happened?”

“Ever since I handed a revolver I picked up to the police, I’ve been learning how to imitate its sound. It seems to be quite effective,” Klein replied half-jokingly.

“That’s not funny, Detective Moriarty,” Kaslana said in a deep voice.

I just wanted to perform some magic for you... Klein lampooned. He handed his cane to the maidservant and solemnly nodded. “I will keep that in mind.”]

Kaslana and Lydia watched over Adol while Stuart and Sherlock rested, then, at midnight, they switched. During the men’s shift, the boy asked to go to the bathroom, and Klein was the one to accompany him. He took this chance to lure out the wraith possessing Adol using Azik’s copper whistle and, with his new abilities as a Magician, burned it. As Adol’s appeared as if he had just awoken from a long nightmare, Klein asked him what had happened to him.

Chapter 300: Spirit Dance

[“I...” Adol turned his head and thought for a few seconds, then he said, “I joined a society; it’s not an ordinary society! We all believe that death is not the end. We can use mysticism to even sense death directly and understand that everything can be reversed. Yes, we believe that the dead can be resurrected!”

Klein, who had just climbed out of his grave more than a month ago chuckled dryly. “You and the others were trying to revive the dead?”

Death is not the end... A world beyond the senses... Everything can be reversed. Mystic sensing... Aren’t these the teachings of the Numinous Episcopate? These were all created to revive Death... He muttered to himself silently in enlightenment.]

After admitting that their society would sometimes dig up graves or buy corpses from hospitals for their experiments, Adol told Klein that they had performed a “Spirit Dance” during the last gathering, after which he couldn’t remember anything. Klein learned from him when and where this society gathered, then warned him from going with them again. He also realized how powerless he was against undead creatures; he was lucky this wraith was weak enough to be destroyed by a simple flame after being lured out of the boy’s body. He lamented no longer having access to Sealed Artifacts like the Mutated Sun Sacred Emblem.

The two left the bathroom and Adol went back to sleep. When it was almost time for the death-worshipping society to gather, Klein went out to the balcony under the guise of smoking a cigarette. He cast an illusion on a paper figurine so that anyone who looked would see Sherlock Moriarty having a smoke, then snuck out to the cemetery where the gathering would happen.

He saw a group of young men and women performing a Spirit Dance, then a man wearing a black robe – who Klein suspected was the member of the Numinous Episcopate using these young people for their experiments – called out for Death and threw a green-eyed black cat at a corpse.

Chapter 301: Awakening

The cat escaped and there seemed to be no changes. But as one of the youths approached the corpse, it suddenly sat up and bit his shoulder. The man wearing a black cloak then blew a brass whistle and commanded the corpse to stop, but then it unexpectedly ran into the depths of the forest. In the woods, Klein held Azik's copper whistle as he led the corpse deeper after him, he then used his Air Bullets before lighting it on fire.

When the Numinous Episcopate member noticed the changes in the forest, he escaped, leaving behind the teenagers who were too afraid to run around in the dark. Klein created an illusion of a clown who questioned the youths about the man who had been with them, learning his name, where he stayed, and that he was their teacher at school. Klein warned them not to do any of this again and advised them to quickly take their bitten friend to a doctor, then he dispelled the illusion.

Klein wanted to teach that cloaked man a lesson but, for the time being, he just snuck back into the house, dispelled the illusion of him smoking in the balcony, and returned to Adol's room. Nothing peculiar happened until daybreak when they switched shifts and Klein was able to catch up on his sleep, briefly hearing Adol telling his father that he was alright now and no one was coming for him.

[At noon, when Klein went downstairs to have a meal, Kaslana sat opposite him and asked with a slight frown, "What happened last night?"

"Nothing," Klein answered simply, and then he laughed. "Does Adol waking up and going to the washroom count?"

Next to him, Stuart slowed down his actions and nodded in agreement. She glanced at their faces, then she retracted her gaze and replied in a low voice, "No."

The corner of Klein's mouth curled up as he skillfully cut his steak.]
(Why is Klein being so sus? Idk he just likes being that way ig)

Chapter 302: A Clue

After receiving a generous payment for this job, Klein started contemplating his financial situation along with how much he needed to save up for Beyonder materials.

[*The good news is that even if I grasp the "acting method," digesting the Sequence 7 potion will take me somewhere between six months to three years. Even if I can quickly conclude the rules of a Magician, I'll*

only be able to push forward that lowest threshold by one to two months. I still have plenty of time to save up and search for clues to these ingredients...]

He returned home, crafted two more paper figurines, and then, in the evening, attended the Eye of Wisdom's gathering. During it, he sold an ingredient to the Apothecary in exchange for some money along with clues to the Apothecary formula.

[Soon after, [the Apothecary's] heart pained, his regret similarly reaching its limit as he sighed emotionally. "You really are a lucky guy! Why didn't I choose that road of fortune..."

I'm the King of Yellow and Black who wields good luck after all... Klein lampooned himself.]

After unsuccessfully trying to haggle, the Apothecary agreed to the deal, handing Klein some cash, a handwritten note, along with the sedatives he had asked for a few gatherings ago. Pocketing the money, Klein immediately read the not.

["On the south side of the Bridge, on Rose Street, at the Harvest Church, find Bishop Utravsky. As long as you help him complete a mission, you'll be able to get the Apothecary formula."

Harvest Church. That's one of the few cathedrals of the Church of Earth Mother in the kingdom. This Church also grasps two Beyonder pathways: "Planter" and "Apothecary" ... The clues match well... Klein thought as he refolded the note.]

Klein asked about a gun and some bullets, only receiving the promise that someone would help him ask around. When he returned home, he got changed and left to confront that member of the Numinous Episcopate.

Chapter 303: Rookie

Klein easily infiltrated that teacher's home, casting illusions to interrogate him. The man seemed to be rookie who didn't fully understand what he was doing, and Klein deduced that he wasn't actually a member of the Numinous Episcopate. The teacher, who had clearly been frightened by what had happened, promised not to dabble in such affairs again, saying that he even resigned from the school he worked at.

As for the Spirit Dance, he told Klein that he had once encountered an old gentleman who had fainted in front of his house from a serious illness. The teacher took the old man in, who then taught him many things about death. But the old man died soon after, leaving behind only a copper whistle. The teacher showed the whistle to Klein and blew it, but didn't seem to notice the Spirit World creature that appeared and tried to touch him. This confirmed to Klein that this man wasn't even a Beyonder at all, as anyone on the Death pathway would be able to see ghosts and all such beings.

Klein advised the teacher to keep visiting a cathedral for a while before asking him to lead him to the old gentleman's grave. The teacher agreed and took Klein to the grave which he started to dig up.

[Kapusky subconsciously looked over when he suddenly let out a miserable scream, retreated a few steps, and fell to the ground.

There was no rotting corpse or bones in the tomb. The bottom layer was littered with white feathers, dyed in yellow oil!]

Chapter 304: Feathers

The feathers reminded Klein of a dream Azik had once described to him, so he reasoned that they must be connected to the Corpse Collector pathway or the Numinous Episcopate. As he collected some of the feathers with his gloved hand, he told the teacher that maybe the corpse had "left by himself," making the man even more afraid. The teacher asked Klein to help him get rid of the copper whistle, to which Klein agreed – he had wanted to study what would happen if he used the messenger of a dead person. (New item acquired: Kapusky's copper whistle)

Back at home, Klein headed above the gray fog where he divined the whistle's origins. He saw the scene of a corpse looking like the old gentleman phase through the grave, with white feathers sprouting from his back. He walked deeper into the darkness and the dream ended. When divining whether using this whistle as the moment was dangerous, Klein received a strong positive reaction, so he just returned to the real world.

Elsewhere, the Apothecary had successfully advanced to Sequence 8 Beast Tamer. He encountered a golden retriever and wanted to test his abilities on her, but she immediately ran away. That golden retriever was Susie, who ran to Audrey, telling her that she saw a scary man. Audrey consoled her then told her that she would have to wait a bit more until the rest of the ingredients for her next potion are gathered, as the coming Beyonder gathering was cancelled because of the serial murders.

On Saturday morning, Klein made his own noodles at home in an attempt to recreate a dish he used to eat when he was a child on earth. As he ate, a knock resounded on his door. It was the detective Isengard Stanton, who wished to cooperate to find the serial killer.

Chapter 305: The Detective Exchange

[A normal private detective would've definitely agreed, both because of the bounty and because of the well-known detective in front of him. A friendship with Isengard would provide him with great benefits in the detective circles.

The problem, however, was that Klein wasn't a normal private detective. He was worried that he would run into the Nighthawks who were in charge of the investigation.]

Klein settled on agreeing to participate in the discussion without being too directly involved in the investigation, claiming to have taken on a very troublesome case. Stanton told him that that was alright, as he had already gathered more than a dozen detectives who were willing to participate, but he still wanted Sherlock Moriarty's opinion as he greatly respected his skills.

As the shook hands, Klein couldn't help suspecting that the other was a Beyonder. Stanton told him that the other detectives were waiting for them at his house, but Klein first excused himself to the bathroom to do a divination above the gray fog. Receiving an acceptable revelation, the two took a carriage over to Stanton's house.

There, Klein found Stuart, Kaslana, and Lydia among the detectives waiting for them, and – after exchanging pleasantries – the discussion about the serial murders started, with Klein silently listening to everyone's opinions. Once they were done, he asked for information about all unsolved serial murder case in the past 20 years in all of Loen.

He believed that, since the killer was advancing from Sequence 6 to 5, then he would have had to fully digest the Sequence 7 Serial Killer potion, during which he would have needed to murder many people regardless of whether he knew the acting method or not. He also believed that the murderer would have been much less experienced back then and so would have left more clues that could have led to him. Of course, Klein only explained the experience part, and Stanton praised his idea.

chapter 306: Giant Bishop

In the evening, Klein was sitting at home flipping through the information Stanton had quickly prepared for him, finding only 9 serial murder cases within the past 20 years. This made sense, as the existence of Beyonder abilities would make finding such killers much easier, despite the fact their technology wasn't as advanced as what he had been used to during his life on earth. He tried thinking from the perspective of the murderers to figure out how they hadn't been caught, even taking into account unique situations like his own, but to no avail.

[*I'm analyzing them by being part of "their kind"... I really didn't fail to live up to the name of Moriarty...* He gave a self-deprecating comment…]

When it was getting dark, Klein left, took a detour, then disguised himself to head to the harvest church for clues about the Apothecary formula. He believed that having an Apothecary as a subordinate would be useful for whenever he got injured or even fell ill under the effect of Beyonder abilities, so he wanted to nurture one himself.

Klein snuck into the church and met the very tall, quite intimidating, yet very gentle Bishop Utravsky. The giant bishop told him that he had once been a pirate who killed many, but then he met some believers of Earth Mother and learned to appreciate the value of life, leaving his old life behind.

[Utravsky sized him up seriously for a while before saying, "I don't think you can fulfill my request."

"Perhaps I can? I need to know the details before I can make an evaluation." Klein frowned.

Utravsky stood there like a giant pillar. After a few seconds, he said, "My request is..."

At this point, he closed his eyes and said, "Kill me."]

Chapter 307: Dawn Paladin

[*Kill you?* It was the first time Klein had heard of such a request, and for a moment, he didn't know how to respond to such a task. He even started to suspect if there was a conspiracy.

Bishop Utravsky opened his eyes and looked down at Klein. "Kill the old me."

...Father, can you not have such long pauses when you're speaking... Klein's mouth twitched as he asked in puzzlement, "Even in the legends and myths, no one can return to the past. I'm afraid this task of yours can only be accomplished by the seven gods."]

Utravsky's explanation led Klein to believe it was a psychological problem like a split-personality, but he also told him that regular and even Beyonder healing methods hadn't worked.

[…"I obtained a very mystical item. It is said to be a relic of an ancient dragon." Seeing that Klein wasn't scared away, Utravsky answered with some hope, "It allows the wielder to enter the deepest part of the target's soul, or, in other words, the bottom of the target's dreamland. There, a corresponding scene will be materialized. That way, you can see the past me directly, and then, through combat, eliminate him. In that special state, once he is truly dead, he will never appear again."]

As for the negative effects, death in the dreamland equated a real death, and exceeding 5 minutes would make Klein's consciousness unable to return to his body. He then learned that Utravsky was a Sequence 6 Dawn Paladin of the Warrior pathway, along with that sequence's abilities. After hearing all of that, Klein left to do divination above the gray fog before returning and accepting the commission.

Utravsky took out the artifact that would help them; a human-skinned candle. Klein prepared himself and everything he always carried around before lighting up the candle, finding himself exactly where he was standing, but facing a much more vicious-looking Utravsky who immediately manipulated the dream to trick Klein.

Chapter 308: A Prepared Magician

Klein wasn't tricked and sent a barrage of Air Bullets towards the evil Utravsky, but they couldn't penetrate the armor he had summoned. The Clown's intuition and agility were all that could save Klein from the bishop's counterattacks, along with the matchsticks he had set up in advance to help him "teleport," only occasionally damaging the armor.

Even when Klein noticed an opening in Utravsky's attacks, it was all calculated, and Klein could barely pull out a piece of paper and harden it to block the giant sword that almost cleaved him in half. He successfully broke through the armor, but had to use one of his Paper Figurine Substitutes in the process. This gave him the perfect chance to shoot Air Bullets into his opponent's head, and Klein then burned the body before leaving the dream.

Chapter 309: Choosing One Out Of Two

As Klein returned to reality, he found Utravsky crying in joy. The giant bishop immediately started his end of the deal and showed two mystical items to pick from, and he chose the Master Key.

["This is called a Master Key. It can help you open any lock which doesn't contain mystical powers, as well as a small number of locks that are augmented with Beyonder effects. And in a place without any locks or doors, it can open a passageway that doesn't belong to reality. Heh heh, the premise is that there are no restrictions by Beyonder powers and the barriers aren't too thick.

“Its spirituality is completely restrained. When it’s not being used, Beyonders cannot see any difference between it and a normal key.”]

[Bishop Utravsky smiled warmly and said, “The person carrying it will occasionally get lost. According to what someone told me, one gets lost at random.”]

Utravsky gave Klein a chance to test the key while he went to retrieve a paper with the Apothecary formula written on it. As Klein left to go home using the key, he got lost for the first time, but it was nothing divination couldn’t solve.

[*I can’t go back without divination?* he silently muttered to himself. He really wanted to stubbornly rely on his own ability to overcome the fact that he was lost. But his hand, which was faster than his voice, had broken the branches of a tree and made a makeshift dowsing rod.

Dowsing Rod Seeking could be used to seek people, as well as items and directions!

This time, Klein was able to return home without incident, and he even confirmed the authenticity of the formula and the latent dangers of the Master Key.]

On Sunday morning, Klein was out to send a letter to detective Stanton when he encountered Mr. and Mrs. Sammer, who told him that Mrs. Mary had successfully joined the National Atmospheric Pollution Council. (She was the one who had hired him to gather evidence of her husband cheating)

Chapter 310: National Atmospheric Pollution Council

After they bade him farewell, Klein found his mail being delivered, with a letter from Stanton. It had the information and ideas he had just written to inquire about.

[*Great detective minds think alike... The letter I wrote just now was for nothing...* Klein joked before returning to the living room.]

After reading through the documents, Klein wrote a letter to Stuart asking him to keep watch over a few suspects. He described the behavior The Sun had told him about Devils and emphasized prioritizing his own safety as these killers could be dangerous.

On Monday, at 3 PM sharp, the Tarot gathering began, with the new member, The Magician Fors, joining them. Audrey immediately noticed the new member and, suspecting it was either Xio or Fors, decided to watch her mannerisms so that she didn’t expose her identity, waiting to see whether the other would figure it out on her own.

Chapter 311: Observing Each Other

The Fool introduced the new member to all the others, and they each started studying each other. Audrey suspected this was Fors, but she couldn’t rule out the possibility of The Fool having pulled in someone else.

[It’s unlikely that Mr. Fool will specially create a fake image for the members, right? There’s no need for “Him” to hide anything...] (Just a very funny thought that Audrey had)

The World requested information about the Devil and Guardian sequences (Sequences 6 and 5 of the Criminal and Warrior pathways, respectively) and Derrick agreed in exchange for information about the True Creator. Fors was shocked at what kind of organization she had joined for them to be discussing powerful beings like the True Creator and sequences that were too high for her to have heard of. The Fool allowed a private exchange.

When The Sun read through the information provided by The World, he started suspecting that the True Creator was the Ancient Sun that the City of Silver believed in but, instead of having abandoned them, he had just gone mad.

In exchange, Klein's attention was brought to the possibility of the murderer being a Devil animal, not a human. He also learned all of their abilities, including one that allows them to sense if someone intended to harm them even days before the attack. That proved to be a big hurdle for a Magician like Klein, whose strength was in strategizing and preparing in advance.

Derrick then went on to describe the abilities of a Guardian.

Chapter 312: A Failed Disguise

Once they were done, Fors, in an attempt not to expose her own pathway for the time being, requested both the Sequence 8 Trickmaster formula for herself, and the Sequence 9 Apothecary formula for Viscount Glaint. This had the opposite effect, as it made Audrey certain this was Fors, Alger figured out she was most likely at Sequence 9, and Klein was mentally facepalming on her behalf.

The World offered the Apothecary formula and promised to help her look for Trickmaster, believing that, since the Master Key seemed to be related to the Apprentice pathway, divining it above the gray fog might yield some corresponding formulas. Fors agreed and The World told her that she could deliver the money by sacrificing it to The Fool. The idea of a sacrifice, along with the way Audrey used specific terms to address The Fool, made Fors fear just how powerful their leader was.

The World gave her the formula and Justice requested The Fool's permission to teach her the acting method, asking him what price he found acceptable in exchange, hoping he wouldn't request pages of Roselle's diary because of the overlap in Audrey and Fors's Beyonder circles.

[*It's not a very important problem since it's just a matter of time before Fors realizes that Mr. Fool wants Roselle's diary, and I would certainly have other Beyonder circles. However, she knows that I have a few pages of Roselle's diary, and if she wants to collect them, she will come to me immediately. However, Mr. Fool has read all of those diary entries... After this gathering, I have to find a chance to tell Fors that all the Roselle diary pages were accidentally lost...* Audrey predicted the chain of events and tried her best to convey her concerns to Mr. Fool in body language.

What's Miss Justice hinting at? Oh, she knows Fors, but she doesn't want to reveal her identity, which means that she doesn't want the payment I request to cause any trouble in that regard... Klein thoughtfully chuckled.

"You can make the decision. You can do the explanation since I do not wish to repeat what I've said in the past."]

Audrey decided to teach her in exchange for some money, along with the condition that she wouldn't tell anyone about this without explicit permission from The Fool.

Chapter 313: The Ancient Deities

After Justice told her, Fors started ruminating over how to act as an apprentice, barely catching The Sun's question: he wanted to know which are the seven orthodox deities they always talked about. This was very confusing for her, as anyone and everyone knew them, so where would this young boy have come from for him not to know?

The World, The Hanged Man, and Justice had all raised their hands to answer him, and The Sun chose to trade with each of them individually then compare their words to form a more comprehensive image. In exchange, they could ask him about the City of Silver. Seeing Fors's blank look, Audrey kindly explained that The Sun wasn't from either of the continents they knew, and that his City of Silver was located somewhere outside of what they could reach and explore.

Audrey had also wanted to flaunt the missions the Tarot Club had already carried out, but she feared this would make Fors associate Audrey with Justice.

[Since she didn't know much about the City of Silver, she didn't know what to ask. Fors didn't participate in the following transaction and chose to spectate from the sidelines. As for The Hanged Man and The World, they successively agreed to The Sun's request.

The happiest of all was Klein, for this meant that he reaped thrice the rewards.

During individual communications, The Fool could hear the conversation! Klein obviously didn't have any plans of insulating himself.]

Each of the 3 members wrote down what they knew and Derrick read through it quickly before waiting for their question. Audrey asked about the Devil pathway, then Alger asked about the creation myth in the City of Silver.

[The slightly tense Derrick relaxed a little and said, "The omnipotent and omniscient God created everything and entered a state of deep slumber.

"The Giant King, Aurmir; the Dragon of Imagination, Ankewelt; the Elf King, Soniathrym; the Vampire Ancestor, Lilith; the Devil Monarch, Farbauti; the Phoenix Ancestor, Gregrace; the Mutant King, Kvastir; and the King of Demonic Wolves, Flegrea split the remnant powers of authority, becoming lords of the sky, land, and ocean. They ruled over reality, the spirit world, and the astral world. They were deities who ruled over various races and were truly deities, the ancient gods."]

The name Flegrea immediately caught Klein's ears, reminding him of the ravings he heard whenever he advanced, but he didn't know what he had to do with the Nation of Evernight on the Hornacis mountain range. So, when it was The World's turn, he asked about Flegrea.

[The Sun, Derrick, looked at Mr. World in astonishment and frowned. "I don't know much about this ancient deity. He's also known as the Annihilation Demonic Wolf and the Evernight Demonic Wolf."

"Evernight Demonic Wolf... Evernight?" Klein slightly narrowed his eyes.]

Chapter 314: Possible

The only conclusion Klein could reach for the moment was that the current Evernight must have inherited her authority from Flegrea, though that would contradict her scripts that said she was a remnant of the Original Creator.

[Klein suddenly made several connections as he manipulated The World to speak. “Is there nothing else?”

“No. Matters regarding the King of Demonic Wolves, Flegrea, is also considered a myth in the City of Silver.” Derrick felt as though he had not given any answers. He suggested out of embarrassment, “Mr. World, you can change to another question.”

Change the question? Little Sun, you’re too honest... Then I won’t stand on ceremony! Klein made The World say hoarsely, “Your honesty and trustworthiness leave a deep impression.” …]

Klein asked whether he knew of a pathway that allowed one to control zombies and transform into a ghost, and Derrick answered that if he was talking about a High-Sequence Beyonder, then it would be the Phoenix pathway, whose Sequence 9 was Corpse Collector. This made Klein connect the Phoenix ancestor from the City of Silver’s myths to the Death pathway, but he knew that Sharron and Maric couldn’t have been High-Sequence Beyonders, so that wasn’t the right pathway.

The most likely answer was the Mutant pathway.

[They were usually the same as humans, but their hearts were always filled with a suppressed, twisted desire in their hearts. Their desires erupted when they came into contact with a certain scene or object, turning into monsters. They would then succumb to their desires for blood and bloodshed.

Every time they unleashed their desires, they would become slightly more merciless and apathetic. Finally, they would lose all their positive feelings that are expected of a human. The most common Mutant was the Werewolf.]

[At this moment, Derrick continued, “The characteristics which Mutants possess happen to form a Beyonder pathway. Therefore, ordinary people can turn into Mutants by consuming potions as well.”

“A Mutant pathway? Which pathway is this referring to? What is the name of the corresponding Sequence 9?” Klein asked curiously through The World.

Derrick ignored the first few questions, treating them as a necessary supplement. “In the City of Silver, the corresponding Sequence 9 is called Prisoner. The mind is the prisoner of the body, and the body is the prisoner of the world. This refers to the madness that is restrained and the desire that is oppressed.”

Prisoner? This pathway is held by the Rose School of Thought. They’re famous for their bloody sacrifices, and worship of the so-called Chained God... Miss Sharron doesn’t look like such a cold-blooded, indiscriminate person... Wait a minute, Maric was apparently being pursued by some faction. Were he and Miss Sharron traitors of the Rose School of Thought? Their betrayal was because they didn’t want to turn into crazy heretics? Klein speculated as he made The World say, “I’m very satisfied with your answer. Transaction complete.”]

After the gathering was over, Klein brought the Master Key above the gray fog to divine its origin. He saw a man in a dark room talking about "restoring the glory of the Abraham family" before drinking a potion. He lost control and died on the spot, with his characteristic forming the ancient-looking key.

[After the dream ended, he opened his eyes and looked forward. He said with a sigh, "Seriously, he said he wanted to restore the glory of the Abraham family, but he failed at the first step... It's risky even at Sequence 9..."

The Abraham family was a powerful aristocratic family of the Tudor Dynasty during the Fourth Epoch. It was said that they held the Beyonder pathway of Apprentice, but it was very likely that it was incomplete.]

After that, Klein responded to Fors's sacrificial ritual before returning to the real world and going over the dossiers again in the hopes of find one that involved an animal.

Chapter 315: Return to Harvest Church

In a cramped room in the City of Silver, Derrick was contemplating then information he had received at the gathering, comparing it to what he knew.

[The so-called God of Combat is very similar to Giant King Aurmir. The Lord of Storms wields authority similar to the Elf King, Soniathrym. The Evernight Goddess appears to be the fusion of the King of Demonic Wolves, Flegrea, and Vampire Ancestor, Lilith. As for the Eternal Blazing Sun, Earth Mother, God of Knowledge and Wisdom, and God of Steam and Machinery, I can't find anyone corresponding to them...]

He left his home and walked to the building that served as the City of Silver's library, hoping to read more about the mythology he didn't like paying attention to at school. Once he found a book, Elder Lovia suddenly came his way, took the book from him, then silently left.

At Klein's place, he hadn't found any promising leads, and he couldn't directly mention the idea of an animal being the killer in order not to expose that he was a Beyonder. Instead, he decided to guide the other detectives by writing to Stanton about how the murderer might not have been practicing on humans, maybe he used to kill many animals to perfect his skills of extracting their organs, as many animals die in the streets on a daily basis with no one batting an eye. While writing these words, Klein realized that they could also be true, so this hint should be very useful for the other detectives' investigations. After sending the letter, Klein encountered lawyer Jurgen.

["Why don't you come to my house as a guest? After dinner, you can go back after dark. I know that you private detectives are very good at climbing." Jurgen invited him in with a serious expression.

Seriously? Klein was stunned for a second before he smiled sincerely. "It's my honor."

After all, Lawyer Jurgen's grandmother had the standard of a capable chef! And he could also tease the cat while he was there!]

After it had gone dark, Klein headed to the harvest church to ask Utravsky about where he had gotten the Master Key. There, he found the bishop walking up the stairs from the basement, which had someone banging loudly on its sealed door.

[At this moment, the basement's stone door was thumped again with ever-increasing intensity. Along with the thumps was a male voice that shouted, "Let me out."

"This is?" Klein couldn't help but ask.

Bishop Utravsky smiled warmly and said, "A vampire."

As soon as he finished, the man in the basement shouted, "What's wrong with being a vampire? Do you think vampires should be locked up here? Do I have to listen to your nagging and scripture recitals every day? Bullshit, I'm a noble Sanguine, so don't use such a vulgar name to describe me! Let me tell you, I worship the moon, and I'll absolutely not convert to a believer of Earth Mother! Give up, you damned priest!"

It was Klein's first time meeting a real vampire, so he couldn't help but ask, "Father, where did you catch him?"

Bishop Utravsky gave Klein an odd look before saying, "He is the original owner of the Master Key. One day, he got lost and entered this cathedral."

...Klein seriously considered the dilemma of whether he should carry the Master Key with him in the future or not.]

[Klein answered frankly, "I want to know where the Master Key first came from."

"You'll have to ask him." Bishop Utravsky pointed to the basement.

The vampire inside suddenly became quiet before he leisurely laughed and said, "Friend, I can answer your question. But the condition is that you rescue me first."]

Chapter 316: Never Perform Unprepared

[*He actually named his price...* Upon hearing the vampire's request, Klein felt both irritated and amused. He looked at the Bishop Utravsky, who was standing in front of him, and asked, "Father, may I borrow your candle? The one that you used last time. I've forgotten what it's called."

Before Bishop Utravsky could reply, the vampire in the basement spoke in a stunned voice. "What do you want to do? What do you want to do?"

At this moment, Bishop Utravsky answered warmly, "It's called the Mental Terror Candle. What are you borrowing it for?"

Father, you're very cooperative. You even knew to ask... The corners of Klein's mouth curled up. "I plan to use it to directly inquire the deepest part of this friend's heart. As you know, I'm quite talented in this area, and I'm very good at such matters..."

Before he could finish his sentence, the vampire in the basement had already shouted, “Bastard, give up on your idea! You will be cursed if you do this to a noble Sanguine! Hey, hey, hey! I’ll speak! I’ll speak! I’ll tell you the origins of the Master Key!”

Klein immediately chuckled. “Thank you for your cooperation.”

“Hmph! The friend of that dirty old man naturally isn’t a good person! As a Sanguine, all I did was go to the hospital to steal blood bottles to drink. Why did I end up locked up in here and forced to listen to this naggy, housefly-like Bible of Life!?” the vampire in the basement angrily complained.]

The vampire told them that he had run into a thief who was trying to enter the finance department of a hospital but had instead gotten lost and ended up in the blood banks, and he even told them the address that the thief said he had found this key at. When Klein used divination, he found out that the vampire was lying, suspecting that he had given them the address of other vampires like him, intending to send Klein to his death.

Once Klein threatened the vampire of giving this address to the churches, he finally told him the real place where the thief had found the Master Key. As Klein was leaving, the vampire told him that his name was Emlyn White. Klein wasn’t going to explore that place for the time being, not until he had a way to purify wraiths in case the dead Apprentice’s spirit still lingered.

On Tuesday morning, Klein received a letter from Stuart where he said that he didn’t find any suspicious behavior in either of the people he was watching. Klein just thanked him and didn’t press for more, as he didn’t want to put the other detective in danger. His plan for the day was to visit the Roselle Memorial Exhibition.

Chapter 317: Roselle Memorial Exhibition

Klein and a group of other people followed a tour guide around as she introduced details about Roselle’s life, but he found those stories boring so he tuned her out and started to check on his wallet.

[Since his wealth had soared to 952 pounds, just a step away from a thousand pounds, his wallet could no longer hold so much cash, and he could only carry some of it selectively. As for the rest, Klein didn’t feel at ease to just leave them at home without protection, so he threw them all above the gray fog.]
(Ah, the start of random stuff being thrown into a pile above the gray fog)

[“That’s the toilet he used, the first toilet in the modern sense.”

Even a toilet he had used before is being exhibited? Klein suddenly felt some sympathy for Roselle.

Then, he looked at the toilet with a flushing system behind the glass wall and saw that it was shimmering with golden light. It seemed to have a layer of gold foil on its surface, and it was engraved with an exaggerated and artistic pattern.

How extravagant... Klein no longer sympathized with Roselle.]

As they walked, the group was introduced to some pages of Roselle’s diary, which the tour guide believed were actually letters to a mysterious lover, and Klein quickly read the visible side.

[“6th March. Dammit, I’m almost constipated from eating the food here!”

“17th March. Are the ladies of Intis so open? Did I hit on her, or did she hit on me? I just find it odd.”

“22nd March. It’s time to choose a religion. On one side is the Church of the Eternal Blazing Sun, and on the other is the Church of Craftsmanship. My choice is without a doubt. Praise you, God of All Machinery! One day, I will make the Church of Craftsmanship change its name to the Church of Machinery.”

...It’s indeed very romantic... Romantic constipation... This should be a diary entry written by Emperor Roselle in his early days. It’s without any valuable information... His handwriting is even uglier than mine... Klein looked away and tsked.]

Klein wondered whether he could manage to sneak back in here after closing time and flip through the pages, but he quickly had to move on to a section where poems and novels written (read: *plagiarized*) by Roselle were displayed. There were even toys among his “inventions”: Chinese Chess and Lego. Klein noticed a brown-haired woman standing in front of this display, staring at everything within it intently.

They were then led to a recreation of Roselle’s study, where there were many of his manuscripts that were left unfinished before his demise, even including a manuscript for a phone. Klein’s attention then fell on a book, noticing a bookmark within it. There were many such books, and, if they were actually the original copies Roselle owned, then there was a chance one of these bookmarks was a Card of Blasphemy.

[He pondered for a moment, and using his Clown’s ability to control his facial muscles, he curiously asked, “Are these all books that Emperor Roselle has read before? Sorry, I mean, are these the original books?”

The female guided nodded firmly. “Yes, these are all the items from Emperor Roselle’s study from back then. They include, but are not limited to, books, manuscripts, bookmarks, lampstands, ink bottles... But even more were destroyed during the several conflicts.”]

He started studying which books had bookmarks in them in an attempt to find out what that “very valuable book” Roselle had mentioned in his diaries was.

[Klein scanned the books, one by one, when his eyes suddenly came to rest on the first pile of manuscripts he saw. They were recording objects from Earth objects which Roselle had wanted to invent but lacked the conditions to do so.

There was also a bookmark in it, and on it, there was a depiction of Roselle in royal Emperor clothes.]

Chapter 318: Verification

[*…Roselle is the kind of person who would claim ‘I’ll hide the secret in the most obvious place, but none of you can find it”...* As Klein imagined this, he added a cackling expression to the Emperor in his mind.]

He wanted to verify that this was actually a Card of Blasphemy before attempting to steal it, but that proved difficult as they were anti-divination and appeared normal using Spirit Vision. The only thing that came to mind was that, as these cards were likely indestructible, attempting to burn them would expose

their abnormality. Klein then noticed a window in the recreated study that served as the light source, as Roselle lived more than a century ago, before gas lamps. He believed that the guards' focus would be on protecting the diary pages, not this exhibition hall, as those were much more popular and more likely to get stolen, but he would still need to do divination above the gray fog.

As for how he would verify before sneaking in to steal the bookmark, he thought of asking Justice to leverage her status as a noble to touch the card and find the chance to attempt destroying it. Klein excused himself to the bathroom, taking this chance to memorize the layout of the exhibition halls and, at noon, left the museum normally along with everyone else.

[Klein had originally wanted to instruct Miss Justice as The Fool, saying that his Blessed needed help. But on second thought, he felt that it would ruin the image of Mr. Fool.

As an unfathomable figure, he has to appear calm and collected. He can't always be helping his Blessed. At the very least, he can't be personally bringing up such matters, time and time again... Klein thought for a moment and quickly worked out a solution.

He decided to pass on the image and voice of his "Blessed's" plea directly to Miss Justice.]

Klein then prayed to The Fool, asking for help in inflicting any kind of small, unnoticeable damage to the bookmark and telling him of there was any reaction. He headed above the gray fog and forwarded the message to Justice.

Chapter 319: Audrey's "Adventure"

Audrey, who was preparing for the special visit the museum had arranged for the nobles after regular visitors left, received The World's request and promised to try, though with no guarantee of success.

[*I cannot let them notice anything unusual. Even if Mr. Fool's Blessed does take any action later, I cannot become a suspect. It's definitely not okay to only touch that bookmark. The moment it's lost, all eyes will be focused on me.*

Yes... So, I need to show equal interest in all the other objects. I cannot let others notice that my main goal is that bookmark. The entire process has to be fluid, nothing sudden, and it has to be reasonable and logical.]

She settled on attempting to pierce the card with an earring, as that would be the most inconspicuous.

In the museum, Audrey acted every bit like a naïve, innocent, and curious young girl, asking for a closer look at many things they encountered, with no one being able to say no to her. That included flipping through the notebook containing pages of Roselle's diary, of which she was able to quickly memorize two.

Once they arrived at the study and were allowed to flip through the manuscripts, Audrey discreetly took off one of her earrings and, on her signal, Susie – who had been following behind them accompanied by a servant – started barking. This pulled everyone's attention, giving Audrey the chance to puncture the bookmark she had been holding. She was met with unusual resistance before she successfully made a small hole, leaving her delighted at this card actually being special.

She remained enthusiastic for the rest of the tour to not arouse suspicion, and it was only after she returned home that she reported everything to The Fool.

Chapter 320: Action

Klein, worried that the damage done to the card would cause it to start showing abnormalities over time, decided to act that very same night. He started planning, doing divinations on the degree of danger, then returned to the real world to finish his preparations. He had wanted to make a fake bookmark to put it in place of the real one, but he felt that would implicate Justice, the last person who touched it. Instead, he decided to steal the bookmark along with multiple random things from the study to throw the official Beyonders off.

He also wanted to infiltrate the museum in his Spirit Body state, but due to the recent murders, he was worried that there would be High-Sequence Beyonders monitoring the streets. So, once it was late enough, he headed to his rented apartment in East Borough, donned a disguise, then slowly made his way to the museum.

In the exhibition halls, Beyonders form the Machinery Hivemind, were patrolling with two Sealed Artifacts: one allowed the wearer to directly view spirit-type beings, and the other formed a sort of invisible barrier around the museum and would give out a warning if breached, allowing them to know exactly where the intruder was. It could also prevent anyone from leaving.

Meanwhile, Klein had used the Master Key to sneak into a building close to the museum. There, he found a secluded spot where he summoned his own spirit then flew to the outside of the museum, changing his face to look like a clown. He followed the shadows and stuck close to the walls so Beyonders wouldn't notice him, but didn't immediately enter as he sensed a mysterious power enveloping the first floor. Instead, he threw a matchbox through the bathroom vents and flew up to the second floor.

Chapter 321: Appearance of A Living Person

The Sealed Artifact exposed the entrance of a none-living thing into the washroom, but the guards, believing it to be a dead leaf, were in no hurry and decided to wait for their patrolling teammates come back so they could inform them to check it out. Meanwhile, Klein had entered the second floor and got close enough to the bathroom without entering the barrier and, with a Magician's Flame Control, lit up the matchbox.

Klein took his chance when the guards were distracted to enter the study, reaching for a different bookmark first before taking the one he actually wanted, just in case someone tried to divine the scene later. As soon as he got them, Klein found himself surrounded by black rifts and overwhelming knowledge. He saw a figure among the bookshelves shrouded in darkness. The woman wearing black leather boots asked him how he knew to only take the bookmarks.

The prepared Klein smiled at her then ended the summoning, returning above the gray fog with everything he had on him. The guards back at the museum were left stunned, as the Sealed Artifact no longer showed any intruders, even though they should not have been able to escape.

Klein didn’t spend long above the gray fog, wanting to first return home before studying the Card of Blasphemy. He returned to the real world and started using the Master Key to open door after door.

[As the formless ripples spread out, he arrived at a neighboring building of the terraces. At this moment, his nose twitched as he smelled a strong stench of blood.

The strong smell of blood! Klein frowned. He looked up and saw a lady laid out in the living room ahead of him. The woman’s expression was filled with pain. There was a large wound at her abdomen, and her internal organs seemed to have disappeared.

At the same time, Klein heard grunting noises.]